



If you have diabetes and become pregnant, talk to your doctor about how to best monitor your blood sugar levels and manage medications.

Epilepsy If you have epilepsy, it's very important to discuss pregnancy with your doctor before you conceive, as certain drugs carry a small risk of causing harm to the developing baby. Nonetheless, it's also important that your epilepsy be controlled. Your doctor will ensure that you are on the lowest possible effective dose of medication before you get pregnant. Women with epilepsy are advised to take 5mg of folic acid for three months prior to conception and for the first 12 weeks of pregnancy. Most maternity units will assign a specialist team to look after women with epilepsy in pregnancy and you will have regular scans to confirm the baby is growing normally. The [anomaly scan](#) will check for problems such as cleft palate, which are slightly more common with certain medications. Most women with epilepsy have an uncomplicated pregnancy. If you have concerns, contact your maternity unit.

Systemic lupus erythematosus This is an autoimmune disorder that can affect many parts of the body, including the kidneys, joints, skin, nervous system, heart, and lungs. The condition is more common in women, and particularly in those of childbearing age. Some women find that the symptoms for this condition ease during pregnancy; however, for some, they can worsen. It's important to control the condition during pregnancy since it can affect the developing baby, with an increased risk of